

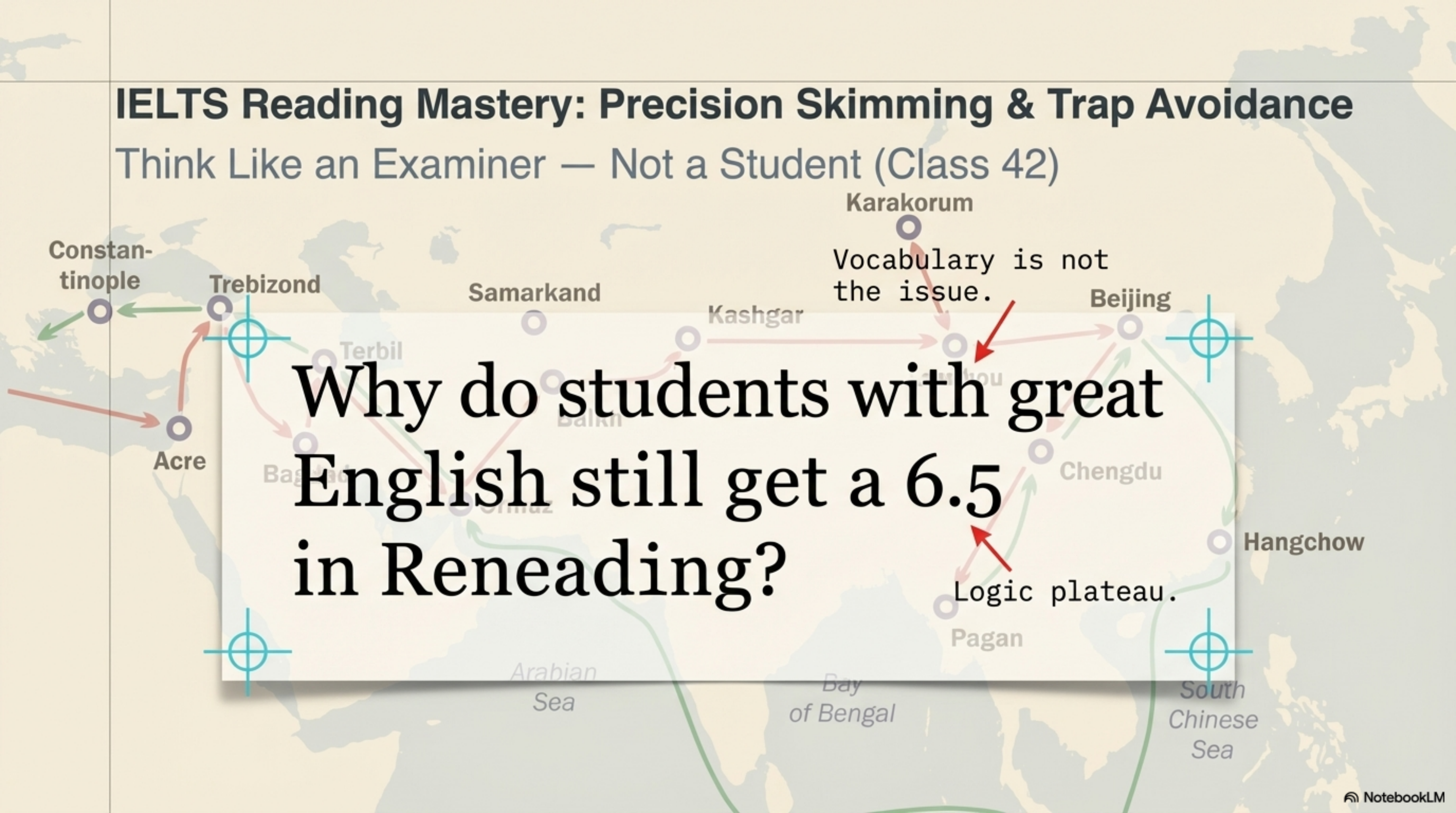
IELTS Reading Mastery: Precision Skimming & Trap Avoidance

Think Like an Examiner — Not a Student (Class 42)

Why do students with great English still get a 6.5 in Reneading?

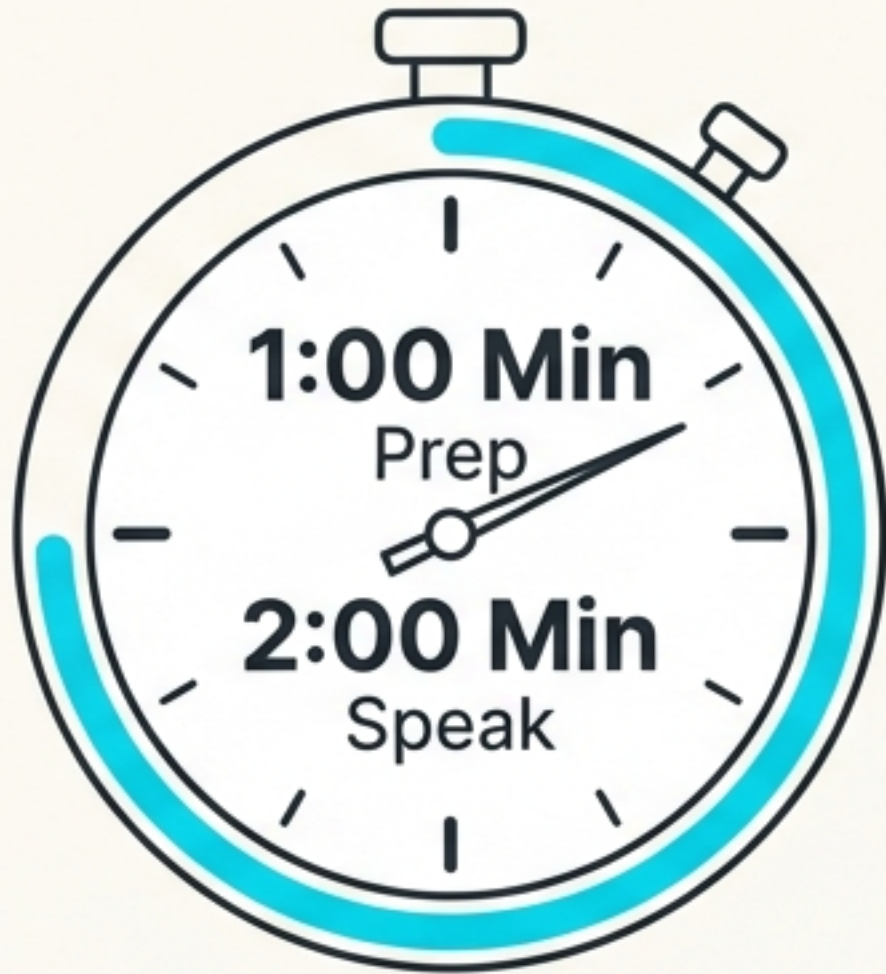
Karakorum
Vocabulary is not the issue.

Logic plateau.



Fluency Activation: The Search

Speaking Part 2



Describe a time when you had to find information quickly.

You should say:

- What the situation was
- Why you needed the information
- How you searched for it
- Whether you were successful

Band 7+ Tip: Don't just list chronological facts. Extend your answers by explaining the logic behind your search. Avoid short, robotic responses.

Why You Are Stuck at 6.5

Today we fix thinking mistakes, not your English. IELTS Reading is a logic test, not just a vocabulary test.

✗ Weak Reader (Band 6.0–6.5)

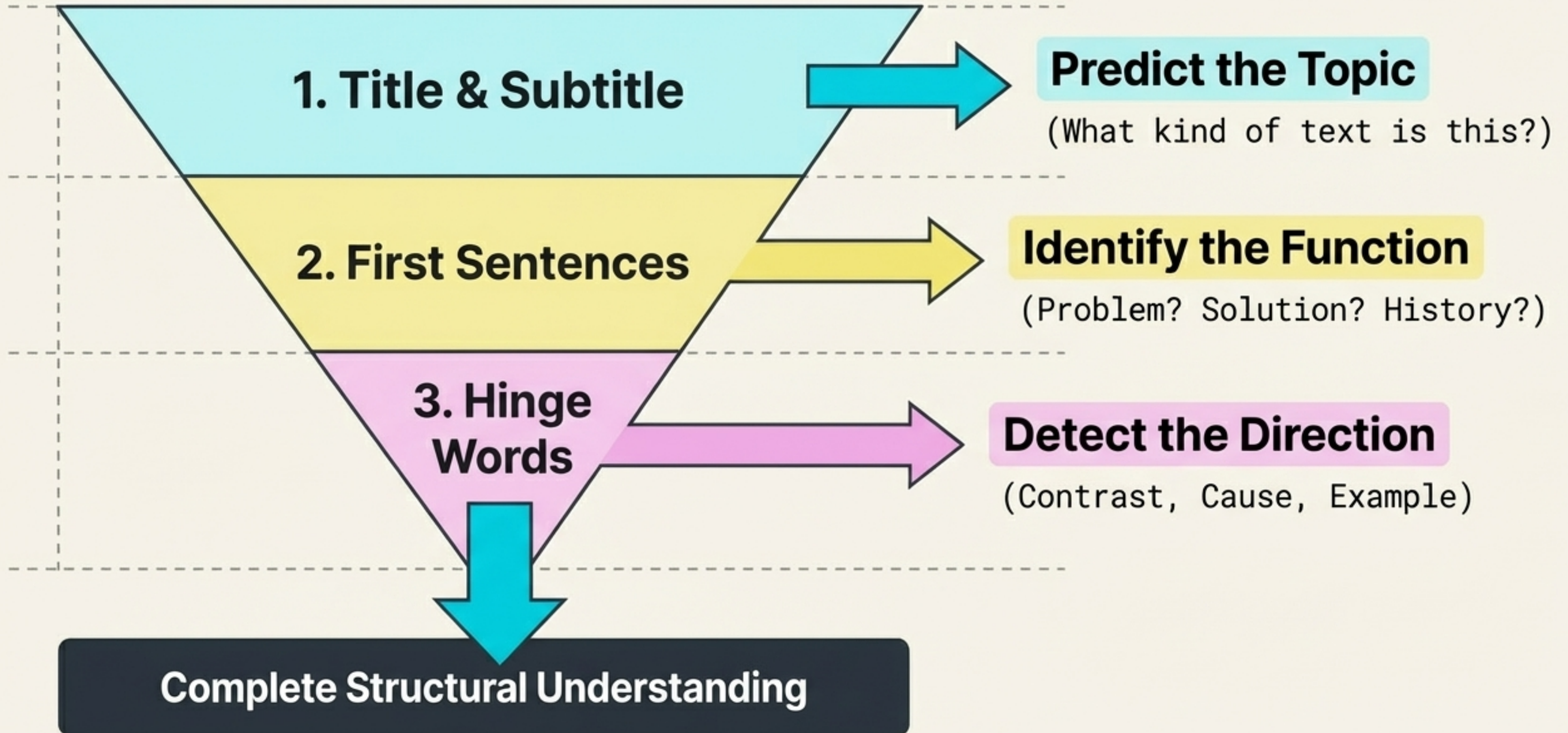
- Reads everything fast in a panic
- Scans for exact keywords like a robot
- Guesses context when lost
- Falls for examiner's logical traps

✓ Strong Reader (Band 7.5+)

- **X-Rays** the text for structure
- **Predicts** answers before scanning
- **Verifies** full logical meaning
- **Hunts** for examiner traps actively

Class Objective: Skim for structure (not words). Scan using prediction. Confidently identify traps.

You Are Not Reading Content. You Are Reading Structure.



Drill 1: X-Ray the Paragraph



You have **60 seconds**. Do not translate. Write a 1-line summary of the paragraph's function.

Mulberry silkworms make cocoons, where from the fine and smooth material is extracted, which is Silk. About 3000 BC, Lei Tzu, wife of the Yellow Emperor ruler, discovered silkworms...

It was discovered that the earliest indication of silk paper was found in the tomb of a noble...

Teacher Note: Push students to realize the function is "**The historical origin of silk**", NOT the specific dates or character names.

Scanning is NOT Keyword Matching



The Myth

[Find the keyword]

[Match the exact word]

[Write the answer]

Result: You fall into the examiner's trap.



The Reality: The P.L.V. System



[P] Predict

What type of answer
is this? (Date?
Opinion? Place?)



[L] Locate

Scan for synonyms,
not the exact word.



[V] Verify

Does the sentence
fully answer the
question logically?

Drill 2: The Paraphrase Engine

The examiner hides answers behind synonyms. Before you locate, you must predict.

Exam Keyword	Predicted Synonyms
Increase	[Surge / Rise / Grow]
Problem	[Issue / Challenge / Difficulty]
Valuable	[Precious / Costly / High-worth]
Decline	[Fall / Drop / Decrease]

Ask yourself: What happens if you only scan for the exact word 'Decline'?

The Examiner is Trying to Trick You

Answers are almost always hidden near **Hinge Words**. These words change the entire meaning of a sentence.



Contrast (Danger Zone)

however, nevertheless,
although, whereas.

Signals the **answer will change direction**.

Cause / Effect

therefore, consequently,
as a result.

Signals the **reason**,
not just a **fact**.

Hedging (T/F/NG Killers)

tends to, may, is likely to,
often.

Turns **definite facts**
into **possibilities**.

Distractor Playbook: Traps 1 & 2

1. The Partial Match Trap

Mechanism: The text matches your keyword... but the meaning stops halfway.

Slip A (Question)

The Romans **knew** who made silk.



Slip B (Text)

The Romans wanted more silk. **But** they **did not know** who was making this wonderful material.

2. The Opposite Meaning Trap

Mechanism: The exact words are used, but a hidden negative completely reverses the logic.

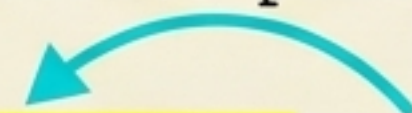
Slip A (Question)

The journey was safe.

Slip B (Text)

The journey was **anything but** safe.

Reverses polarity



Distractor Playbook: Traps 3, 4 & 5

3. The Time Trap

Confusing Past, Present, and Future. (e.g., “was” vs “is now”).

4. Cause vs. Result Trap

Swapping the reason with the effect.

5. Extreme Language Trap

‘Many’ ≠ ‘All’. ‘Better’ ≠ ‘Best’.

Question: Gold was the **most** valuable material on the Silk Road.

Examiner Note:

Watch for extreme absolutes. Does the text actually say ‘most’, or just that it was valuable?

Drill 3: Correct or Trap? You Decide.

Read the sentence and decide: Is this the answer, or is it a trap? **If it's a trap, WHICH ONE?**

Q: "All soldiers returned from the Silk Road."

Text: "Most of the soldiers never returned."

[?]

Answer: Extreme/Opposite Trap

Q: "Nylon caused a drop in silk production."

Text: "...nylon and other manmade fibres cause decline in silk production."

[?]

Answer: Correct - Paraphrase (drop = decline)

The Master Challenge: "The Story of Silk"

The Romans discovered pieces of silk from the people they conquered. Silk quickly became popular in Rome. Rome had gold and silver, but they wanted more silk. They did not know who was making this wonderful material...

About 3000 BC, Lei Tzu, wife of the Yellow Emperor ruler, Lei Tzu, wife of the Yellow Emperor ruler, discovered silkworms...

By the 20th century, nylon and other manmade fibres cause decline in silk production.

04:00 

1. [T/F/NG] Gold was the most valuable material transported along the Silk Road.
2. [Fill in] 20th century: _____ and other manmade fibres cause decline in silk production.
3. [Multiple Choice] Who originally discovered silkworms?
(A) Yellow Emperor
(B) Lei Tzu
(C) Lao Tzu

Post-Mortem: How Did You Think?

✗ Q1: Gold was the most valuable material transported along the Silk Road.

✓ **NOT GIVEN**

*Trap Revealed: Extreme Language.
The text says Rome had gold, but
never ranks it as "most" valuable.*

✗ Q2: 20th century: ✓ **NYLON** cause decline
decline in silk production.

*Paraphrase Revealed: "drop" in the
question = "decline" in the text.*

✗ Q3: Who originally discovered silkworms?
(A) Yellow Emperor
(B) Lei Tzu
(C) Lao Tzu

✓ **B. Lei Tzu**

Trap Revealed: Partial Match. The text mentions "Yellow Emperor" but specifies his wife Lei Tzu made the discovery.

Rewire Your Reading



Self-Audit Questions:

1. Which logical trap do you fall into most often? (Extreme language? Partial match?)
2. Are you currently skimming for words, or skimming for structure?
3. What is ONE specific action you will change in your reading strategy today?

If you fix your logic, your score jumps from 6.5 to 7.5 automatically.

The Band 7.5+ Blueprint

Skim for Structure

(Title -> First Sentences
-> Hinge Words)

Scan with P.L.V.

(Predict, Locate,
Verify)

Hunt Hinge Words

(Contrast, Cause,
Hedging)

Spot Distractors

(Don't just match
exact words)



The Assignment:

- Complete ONE reading passage this week.
- Do NOT time yourself.
- Focus only on identifying paraphrasing and mapping out traps.
- Keep a 'Mistake Log'.